The superintendent of Jail 3, D. P. Diwedi, requested its inmates to 'donate' their labour under a *shram daan* scheme. The inmates did not hesitate and their beaming superintendent declared: 'In a week's time the complete prison bore a new look, with the entire premises cleaned up and all the buildings whitewashed. We had been contemplating over requesting the PWD [Public Works Department] to assist us in this task but our own prisoners suggested that they would do it themselves. And a more professional job we could not have seen.'

All the superintendents collectively expressed the need to incorporate such discipline as part and parcel of their duties. No amount of rules and regulations in jail manuals, they maintained, would be able to help them if they did not put their hearts into what they were doing. Only that would put life into the system and make it a permanent achievement of Tihar.

With the perceptible changes and reforms then taking place in Tihar, one was quite convinced that the inmates' conditions would be considerably ameliorated. However, how could the ultimate goal, of making the prison system a part of the crime prevention package, be achieved?

Kiran Bedi pondered over this question and then replied:

> The biggest tragedy I perceive is that there is no coordination in the administrative system. Each department is, in principle, linked with the other. Yet it works in complete isolation. One is not even aware of the workings of the other. We have never looked at criminal justice in a holistic way. The police does not understand why we are doing something in the prison. We have a lot of things to tell them, but they have no time for us. If they would coordinate with the prison authorities, and develop a sensitivity in the police force – after all we are both trying to bring the crime rate down – if we are to sustain our efforts then there should be certain inputs into their training. To sustain this it is absolutely necessary to develop a crime prevention package. We must have a coordinating system and develop coordinating skills. But this coordination can come only from a political or administrative leadership – the home minister or the home secretary. They should develop coordination skills and not be just seeking explanations, not just seeking reports and reprimanding but be looking at broader issues and grappling with them. What I'm suggesting is not something idealistic. It's a management exercise that can very well be understood and learned. With this coordination would come interaction among the concerned departments – the police, the judiciary and the prison.
>
> How do we prevent recidivism? First we need to know what's causing it. There must be a feedback to the prison. The police can monitor this. They can have month-to-month reports on the activities of released criminals. Only they can tell us what measures they are taking to prevent recidivism and what their crime prevention plan is.
>
> The end-product is the public. Voluntary agencies must take on the task of overseeing the ex-prisoners' rehabilitation into society. NGOs (non-governmental organizations) can do a lot here.
>
> At present we have a situation where we are told 'don't touch me, I'm judiciary' or 'I'm police'. But each, in turn, feels free to criticize the other. So the coordination can only come at the political level, that is, at the ministry level. The ministry would point out then – 'You gentleman/lady, you are not being able to fit into this programme. So, it is better we put you somewhere else where your particular attitude would be better suited.'
>
> In the West and in some of the Asia Pacific regions, they are working on these lines. They have a range of after-care officers. We are far behind in this. But now at least we are aware of the problems we face and that's as good a start as any for doing something about it.
>
> We banned smoking for the prisoners because it is a stimulation dependence just as any other